# Papers 3 and 4 — past-paper audit and November 2026 priorities

Cambridge Islamic Studies 9488 • Research cut-off: 29 October 2026. Independent revision guidance, not Cambridge predictions.

## Read this before the predictions

20 listed live question papers were read as extracted text: components 32 and 42, ten sessions from November 2021 to June 2026. The audit contains 40 Paper 3 question groups (80 separately marked parts) and 30 Paper 4 essays: 110 marked prompts. Two official specimen papers were also checked but are excluded from counts. No target November 2026 paper was sought or used.

**Collection limitation:** original PDF bytes have NOT been downloaded into this repository. Online extraction allowed question reading but does not preserve or reliably describe source images. The CSV/JSON manifests distinguish indexed, partially reviewed and fully reviewed resources. All 20 schemes are linked, but only June 2026 schemes were fully read; November 2025 schemes were partly read. Examiner advice is based on the official June 2024 report, not a claimed review of every report.

May/June 2021 was absent from the discovered index; a direct Paper 3 request redirected to the mirror home page. That does not prove no such paper existed. No other variants or unavailable sessions are silently counted. Older 8053/9013 papers are not treated as 9488 evidence. The 2021–2023 papers belong to an earlier syllabus cycle: they are historical practice evidence, not authority overriding the 2024–2026 syllabus.

## What the exam requires

Paper 3: 90 minutes, 50 marks. Choose one question from Section A and one from Section B. Each has (a) 10 AO1 marks and (b) 15 AO2 marks. Section A(a) requires the figure plus own knowledge. Paper 4: 90 minutes, two essays from three, each 25 marks assessed as AO1 10 and AO2 15. Paper 4 does not divide essays into (a)/(b).

## Counting method

Each CSV row is one 25-mark question, not one sitting or one candidate answer. P3 parts are summarised separately in the row. Tags are human-coded from question wording and are not an official taxonomy. A tag is counted once per question group; multiple tags may overlap. P4 uses women / pluralism / leadership as non-exclusive themes. Counts are descriptions, not probabilities.

## Broad topic coverage

### Paper 3

- Syllabus 3.1: 10 question groups.
- Syllabus 3.2: 10 question groups.
- Syllabus 3.3: 10 question groups.
- Syllabus 3.4: 10 question groups.

### Paper 4

- Syllabus 4.1: 11 question groups.
- Syllabus 4.2: 9 question groups.
- Syllabus 4.3: 10 question groups.
- Women tag (including crossovers): 12 / 30 essays, across 10 / 10 sessions.

- Pluralism tag (including crossovers): 13 / 30 essays, across 10 / 10 sessions.
- Leadership tag (including crossovers): 12 / 30 essays, across 10 / 10 sessions. Do not add these overlapping counts to obtain a total. In June 2026 both Q1 and Q3 involve other faiths; a neat one-question-per-theme assumption fails.

## Paper 3 recurring question families

- 3.1, **religion**: 5/10 groups; s22 Q1, w22 Q1, w23 Q1, w24 Q1, s25 Q1.
- 3.1, **architecture**: 3/10 groups; w21 Q1, s25 Q1, w25 Q1.
- 3.1, **leadership**: 3/10 groups; s22 Q1, s23 Q1, s24 Q1.
- 3.1, **interfaith**: 2/10 groups; w22 Q1, s26 Q1.
- 3.2, **religion**: 3/10 groups; w21 Q2, s23 Q2, w25 Q2.
- 3.2, **leadership**: 3/10 groups; w21 Q2, s22 Q2, w24 Q2.
- 3.2, **science**: 3/10 groups; w22 Q2, s24 Q2, s26 Q2.
- 3.2, **translation**: 2/10 groups; w23 Q2, s25 Q2.
- 3.3, **reason**: 4/10 groups; w21 Q3, s23 Q3, s24 Q3, w25 Q3.
- 3.3, **natural-signs**: 2/10 groups; w23 Q3, s25 Q3.
- 3.3, **significant-work**: 3/10 groups; s22 Q3, w22 Q3, w24 Q3.
- 3.3, **dawah**: 4/10 groups; s22 Q3, w22 Q3, w24 Q3, s26 Q3.
- 3.4, **continuity**: 3/10 groups; w22 Q4, s24 Q4, s25 Q4.
- 3.4, **diversity**: 3/10 groups; w22 Q4, w23 Q4, w25 Q4.
- 3.4, **texts-versus-buildings**: 3/10 groups; w21 Q4, s23 Q4, s26 Q4.
- 3.4, **domes**: 2/10 groups; w24 Q4, s25 Q4.

Tag boundaries matter: e.g. an art feature might appear without a specific “architecture” tag. Use the complete audit below, not isolated counts.

# Cautious November 2026 forecast: what to rehearse first

**High confidence:** the published format and assessment objectives. **Moderate confidence:** the usefulness of recurring comparison/evaluation skills. **Low confidence:** any exact November topic or wording. There is no validated forecasting model, no numerical likelihood and no reason to regard a topic as “due”. June appearances do not rule out November repeats.

## Paper 3 — first-pass priorities (not exclusions)

1. **Umayyad policy judgement with architecture as evidence.** Practise religious versus political/educational/economic purposes and evaluate Qur’an/Sunnah conformity by individual ruler. Historical anchors: w23 Q1, s24 Q1, w24 Q1, s25 Q1. Refresh interfaith Spain and minarets too: s26 Q1 and w25 Q1 show how the angle changes.
2. **Abbasid openness, science and legacy against dynastic comparison.** Prepare translation -> criticism/testing -> preservation/transmission, plus religious policy and political power. Anchors: w23 Q2, s24 Q2, s25 Q2, w25 Q2, s26 Q2. Revise one named scientist deeply and supporting medicine breadth so a medical stimulus does not strand you.
3. **Reason, revelation, natural signs and da'wah.** Prepare two actual works, not biographies alone. The alternation between Greek comparison, natural signs and communicating beliefs is a question-family observation, not a rotation rule: s23/w25 Q3, w23/s25 Q3, w24/s26 Q3.
4. **Meaning of art plus continuity/diversity; buildings versus texts.** Learn two contrasting mosques, gardens/Paradise, calligraphy, geometry and domes. Anchors: w23 Q4 (two mosques), s24/s25 Q4 (change), w25 Q4 (diversity), s26 Q4 (calligraphy/texts). Gardens still need revision despite fewer sampled live occurrences.

### Paper 4 — first-pass priorities (not exclusions)

1. **Justice, consultation, obedience and legitimate criticism.** Combine Qur'anic criteria with the four caliphs, two reformers and a recent leader. Practice democratic mechanisms versus religious principles rather than equating shura with a modern election. Anchors: w22 Q2, s23 Q2, s25 Q1, w25 Q2.
2. **Women's rights/agency, public leadership and education under real constraints.** Use early, historical and modern women; distinguish Islamic teaching from custom, and eligibility from performance. Anchors: s23 Q1, s24 Q3, w24 Q1, s25 Q2, s26 Q2.
3. **Religious pluralism in practice: majority/minority, law and cooperation.** Prepare two communities, Medina/Umar and the chosen historical case. Define theological disagreement separately from civic equality. Anchors: s23 Q3, s24 Q2, w24 Q3, w25 Q3, s26 Q1/Q3.
4. **Crossovers deliberately.** Women as leaders; leaders protecting non-Muslims; women in minorities; past-to-present comparisons. s23 Q2, w23 Q1/Q3, s24 Q3, s25 Q2 and s26 Q3 are direct warnings against siloed revision.

## Question-by-question audit

These are editorial paraphrases, not a verbatim replacement for the original papers. Always inspect the original source figure. s24 Q1 extraction included an unreliable image description calling al-Aqsa the holiest site; that generated description is not used as exam text or historical evidence. w22 Q2 figure caption could not be recovered.

### October/November 2021 (w21)

#### Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1

- (a), 10 AO1: Architecture expressing Islamic belief.
- (b), 15 AO2: Continuity between Umayyad and pre-Islamic art and culture.
- Source: Minaret.

- Tags: architecture, continuity. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Early Abbasid religious policies.
- (b), 15 AO2: Rule according to Qur'an and Sunnah.
- Source: Teaching scene.
- Tags: religion, leadership. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Reasoning in philosophical writings.
- (b), 15 AO2: Similarities and differences with ancient Greek philosophy.
- Source: None.
- Tags: reason, Greek. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Geometry and God as Creator.
- (b), 15 AO2: Understanding tawhid through architecture versus writings.
- Source: None.
- Tags: geometry, texts-versus-buildings. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Aisha as a role model for twenty-first-century women.
- Tags: women, role-model. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Difficulties practising faith alongside other religions.
- Tags: pluralism, minority. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Political competence versus faith of leader.
- Tags: leadership, faith-competence. Original question paper.

## May/June 2022 (s22)

### Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1

- (a), 10 AO1: Promotion of Islam.
- (b), 15 AO2: Whether caliphs followed the Qur'an in everything.
- Source: Umayyad Qur'an.
- Tags: religion, leadership. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2

- (a), 10 AO1: Strong Abbasid leadership.
- (b), 15 AO2: Change in caliphal leadership under Abbasids.
- Source: Palace in Iraq.
- Tags: leadership, dynasty-comparison. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3

- (a), 10 AO1: One significant writing expressing beliefs.
- (b), 15 AO2: Different methods of explaining beliefs to others.
- Source: None.
- Tags: significant-work, dawah. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4

- (a), 10 AO1: Gardens reflecting the afterlife.
- (b), 15 AO2: Gardens as the easiest way to understand Paradise.
- Source: None.
- Tags: gardens, paradise. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.3

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Difficulty ruling by laws of God today.
- Tags: leadership, modern-law. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Contribution while keeping Islamic teachings; one modern woman.
- Tags: women, modern-case. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Extent of interaction with other faiths.
- Tags: pluralism, interaction. Original question paper.

## October/November 2022 (w22)

**Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1**

- (a), 10 AO1: Religious policies.
- (b), 15 AO2: Legacy of good interfaith relations.
- Source: Great Mosque Damascus.
- Tags: religion, interfaith. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Contribution of one famous scientist.
- (b), 15 AO2: Foundations of modern science.
- Source: Figure 2.1: inspect original; caption missing in text extraction.
- Tags: science, legacy. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Beliefs and values in one significant writing.
- (b), 15 AO2: How one work helps others understand Islam.
- Source: None.
- Tags: significant-work, dawah. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4

- (a), 10 AO1: Islamic versus pre-Islamic Arabian art.
- (b), 15 AO2: Embracing diverse cultural expressions through art.
- Source: None.
- Tags: continuity, diversity. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Whether women have same rights as men.
- Tags: women, rights. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.3

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Democratic rule and Four Rightly Guided Caliphs.
- Tags: leadership, democracy. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Importance of freedom of expression in plural society.
- Tags: pluralism, expression. Original question paper.

## May/June 2023 (s23)

### Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1

- (a), 10 AO1: Development of leadership.
- (b), 15 AO2: Most successful feature of Umayyad leadership.
- Source: Hisham's Palace Palestine.
- Tags: leadership, policy-evaluation. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2

- (a), 10 AO1: Following the Sunnah.
- (b), 15 AO2: Umayyads and Abbasids compared against Sunnah.

- Source: Scholarly discussion.
- Tags: religion, dynasty-comparison. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Main features of falsafah.
- (b), 15 AO2: Islamic and Greek philosophy compared.
- Source: None.
- Tags: reason, Greek. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Importance of architecture.
- (b), 15 AO2: Philosophy versus architecture for Muslims today.
- Source: None.
- Tags: architecture, texts-versus-buildings. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Difficulty being promoters of knowledge.
- Tags: women, knowledge. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Justice and human rights with reference to either women or non-Muslims.
- Tags: leadership, women, pluralism, justice. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Improving relations in one Muslim-minority country.
- Tags: pluralism, minority, interfaith. Original question paper.

## October/November 2023 (w23)

**Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1**

- (a), 10 AO1: Development of education and trade.
- (b), 15 AO2: Relative importance of religious policies.
- Source: Umayyad coins.
- Tags: education-trade, religion. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Translation movement.
- (b), 15 AO2: Success through openness to other traditions.
- Source: Socrates.
- Tags: translation, openness. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Meaning in natural signs.
- (b), 15 AO2: Natural signs versus revelation as ways of learning.
- Source: None.
- Tags: natural-signs, revelation. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Beliefs in one studied mosque.
- (b), 15 AO2: Comparison of features of two studied mosques.
- Source: None.
- Tags: mosque-case-study, diversity. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Challenges facing women in Muslim-minority countries.
- Tags: women, pluralism, minority. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Contemporary leaders developing Muslim practice.

- Tags: leadership, modern-case. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Pious Muslims effectively leading Muslims and non-Muslims.
- Tags: leadership, pluralism, faith-competence. Original question paper.

## May/June 2024 (s24)

**Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1**

- (a), 10 AO1: Political leadership.
- (b), 15 AO2: Political leadership as main purpose.
- Source: Umayyad palace remains Jerusalem.
- Tags: leadership, policy-evaluation. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Methods used in science.
- (b), 15 AO2: Claim that Abbasids were first scientists.
- Source: Astronomers.
- Tags: science, methods. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Reasoning about creation.
- (b), 15 AO2: Connection with environmental care.
- Source: None.
- Tags: reason, environment. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Interpretation of three features.
- (b), 15 AO2: Differences from pre-Islamic Arabian art.
- Source: None.

- Tags: art-symbolism, continuity. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Whether role should be greater inside or outside household.
- Tags: women, family-career. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Limits on dawah in a Muslim-minority country.
- Tags: pluralism, minority, dawah. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Extent to which women can be leaders.
- Tags: women, leadership. Original question paper.

## October/November 2024 (w24)

**Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1**

- (a), 10 AO1: Religious leadership.
- (b), 15 AO2: Religious leadership as main purpose.
- Source: Umayyad constructions.
- Tags: religion, policy-evaluation. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Strengthening Abbasid rule.
- (b), 15 AO2: Power of caliphs as inspiration today.
- Source: Mahmud of Ghazni receiving caliphal robe.
- Tags: leadership, legacy. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: One work used to invite people to Islam.

- (b), 15 AO2: Different sources for different audiences.
- Source: None.
- Tags: significant-work, dawah. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Meaning of domes and geometry.
- (b), 15 AO2: Architecture communicating beliefs about God.
- Source: None.
- Tags: domes, geometry. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Modesty and achievement; two women including a modern woman.
- Tags: women, modesty, modern-case. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Present and past challenges applying Sunnah.
- Tags: leadership, Sunnah, past-present. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Muslims' role in a Muslim-minority country.
- Tags: pluralism, minority. Original question paper.

## May/June 2025 (s25)

**Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1**

- (a), 10 AO1: Development of architecture.
- (b), 15 AO2: Mosque building as most significant religious policy.
- Source: Great Mosque Aleppo.
- Tags: architecture, religion. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2**

- (a), 10 AO1: Translation movement open to other traditions.
- (b), 15 AO2: Education compared with religious facilities.
- Source: Illustrated Kalila and Dimna.
- Tags: translation, openness. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3**

- (a), 10 AO1: Scholarly interpretation of natural signs.
- (b), 15 AO2: Extent to which main teachings can be found in nature.
- Source: None.
- Tags: natural-signs, revelation. Original question paper.

**Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4**

- (a), 10 AO1: Meaning and function of domes.
- (b), 15 AO2: Complete change in religious architecture with Islam.
- Source: None.
- Tags: domes, continuity. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Responsibilities towards leaders.
- Tags: leadership, obedience. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Political office and religious values; contemporary woman.
- Tags: women, leadership, modern-case. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Addressing modern challenges together with other faiths.
- Tags: pluralism, interfaith. Original question paper.

## October/November 2025 (w25)

### Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1

- (a), 10 AO1: Nature and purpose of minaret.
- (b), 15 AO2: Contrast with pre-Islamic art.
- Source: Minaret of the Bride Damascus.
- Tags: architecture, continuity. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2

- (a), 10 AO1: Promotion of Qur'anic teachings.
- (b), 15 AO2: Comparison with Umayyads in promoting Qur'anic teachings.
- Source: Early Abbasid Qur'an.
- Tags: religion, dynasty-comparison. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3

- (a), 10 AO1: Limitations on logic in falsafah.
- (b), 15 AO2: Claim of total difference from Greek logic.
- Source: None.
- Tags: reason, Greek. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4

- (a), 10 AO1: Cultural diversity in Islamic art.
- (b), 15 AO2: Inventing new styles reflecting modern life.
- Source: None.
- Tags: diversity, modern-art. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.1

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Practising religion more challenging now than in past.
- Tags: women, past-present. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.3

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Continuity of leadership qualities.
- Tags: leadership, past-present. Original question paper.

### Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.2

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Extent to which Islam supports religious pluralism.
- Tags: pluralism, teachings. Original question paper.

## May/June 2026 (s26)

### Paper 3, Q1 — syllabus 3.1

- (a), 10 AO1: Interfaith relations in Muslim Spain.
- (b), 15 AO2: Influence of interfaith legacy today.
- Source: Interior of Cordoba Mosque.
- Tags: interfaith, legacy. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q2 — syllabus 3.2

- (a), 10 AO1: Contributions to medicine.
- (b), 15 AO2: Whether scientists merely copied Greeks.
- Source: Diagram of human body.
- Tags: science, Greek. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q3 — syllabus 3.3

- (a), 10 AO1: Three methods of inviting others to Islam.
- (b), 15 AO2: Most appropriate method today.
- Source: None.
- Tags: dawah, methods. Original question paper.

### Paper 3, Q4 — syllabus 3.4

- (a), 10 AO1: Calligraphy expressing belief in God.

- (b), 15 AO2: Books versus architecture in communicating belief.
- Source: None.
- Tags: calligraphy, texts-versus-buildings. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q1 — syllabus 4.2**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Treatment of non-Muslims now compared with early Islam.
- Tags: pluralism, past-present. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q2 — syllabus 4.1**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Hijab as protection; different views.
- Tags: women, modesty. Original question paper.

**Paper 4, Q3 — syllabus 4.3**

- Essay, 25 (AO1 10 + AO2 15): Leaders' approaches to other faiths; Mughal emperors or Muslim Spain.
- Tags: leadership, pluralism, historical-case. Original question paper.

## Official specimen baseline (not counted)

Paper 3: architectural features and Umayyad Qur’an/Sunnah conformity; Abbasid medicine and education compared with Umayyads; falsafah/revelation; gardens/Paradise and environmental care. Paper 4: significance of two women; respect/equality for other faiths; political leader’s religious commitment. Links are in the manifest.

## Verified examiner/mark-scheme lessons

June 2024 report, P3: distinguish the exact kind of leadership; explicitly interpret the figure; explain scientific methods rather than listing names; compare perspectives in AO2; answer the specified number of features. P4: use relevant contemporary examples and Qur’an/Hadith; answer “which role is greater” rather than merely describing roles; minority-context questions cannot be answered with a majority-country case.

June 2026 schemes: AO1 top level 9–10 requires detailed accurate relevant knowledge and developed understanding. AO2 top level 13–15 requires detailed analysis of the strength/importance of competing views, accurate evidence, coherent argument and a conclusion assessing alternatives. A long list of views without weighing them is insufficient.

**Source criticism matters:** indicative schemes offer creditable arguments, not a flawless history textbook. Do not repeat broad claims that every Abbasid scientist served an Abbasid caliph, or that Islamic art never contained figures. Ibn al-Haytham worked in Fatimid Egypt. Historical evidence should remain precise even where an exam groups intellectual achievements under the Abbasid-era heading.

## Source register and download status

All indexed originals and review statuses are in sources/resource_manifest.csv and .json. scripts/download_sources.py downloads outside this restricted network, checks PDF signatures, detects HTML redirects, records failures and saves SHA-256 hashes. Empty/missing files are not counted as collected. Report links absent from the index are not invented: w25/s26 report requests redirected to the mirror homepage and are not validated resources.

- 9488_w21_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w21_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w21_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w21_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s22_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s22_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.

- 9488_s22_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s22_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w22_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w22_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w22_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w22_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s23_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s23_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s23_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s23_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w23_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w23_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w23_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w23_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s24_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.

- 9488_s24_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s24_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s24_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w24_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w24_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w24_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w24_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s25_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s25_ms_32.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s25_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s25_ms_42.pdf — indexed; content not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w25_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w25_ms_32.pdf — partially reviewed (chunk 1); original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w25_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w25_ms_42.pdf — partially reviewed (chunk 1); original stored locally: no.

- 9488_s26_qp_32.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s26_ms_32.pdf — fully reviewed as extracted text; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s26_qp_42.pdf — question text reviewed; images not independently inspected; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s26_ms_42.pdf — fully reviewed as extracted text; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w21_er.pdf — indexed; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s22_er.pdf — indexed; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w22_er.pdf — indexed; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s23_er.pdf — indexed; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_w23_er.pdf — indexed; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_s24_er.pdf — P3/P4 sections reviewed (chunks 2 and 3); original stored locally: no.
- 9488_2024_2026_syllabus.pdf — A2 content and assessment sections reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_2021_sp_3.pdf — question text reviewed; excluded from frequencies; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_2021_sm_3.pdf — linked from official index; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_2021_sp_4.pdf — question text reviewed; excluded from frequencies; original stored locally: no.
- 9488_2021_sm_4.pdf — linked from official index; not reviewed; original stored locally: no.